Coaching Codex

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COACHING CODEX · GUIDE 04 · CHATGPT & LLM PROMPTING FOR BUSINESS

ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini or Copilot? Pick the Right AI Assistant

Stop tool-hopping. Answer a few simple questions, choose one assistant that fits how you already work, and set it up safely in 15 minutes.

4	15 min	1
assistants compared	decision + setup	business context note

START HERE

Too many AI apps? You only need one to start.

ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini and Microsoft Copilot can all write, summarise, brainstorm and explain. For most small businesses the best choice isn't the ‘smartest’ assistant. It's the one that fits the tools you already use, the way you work and your budget.

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Assistants
A plain-English look at the big four and what each is known for.

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Questions
A quick decision checklist that points you to one choice.

15
Minutes
To set up custom instructions, privacy settings and your first note.

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A NOTE ON CHANGE

AI tools add features and change prices often. This guide focuses on **how to decide**, which stays useful. Always check each tool's current plans and terms before you pay.

SECTION 01 · THE BASICS

What every AI assistant does well, and where they all slip

All four assistants are built on large language models. They are excellent with words and patterns, and weak whenever they must be exactly right without checking.

Great at	Be careful with
Drafting emails, posts and replies	Facts, prices, dates and laws (always verify)
Summarising long documents and notes	Maths in long chains (ask it to show working)
Brainstorming ideas and names	Recent events (depends on web access)
Rewriting in a different tone	Confidential data (follow your settings and policy)
Explaining things simply	Sounding sure when it is wrong

The one-line rule

AI drafts, you decide. Treat every answer like work from a fast, keen new hire: useful, but checked before it reaches a customer.

PROMPT · TEST HONESTY

I run [TYPE OF BUSINESS] in [CITY]. Answer this question: [YOUR QUESTION].
Then list which parts of your answer I should double-check, and why.

EXERCISE 1 · YOUR TOP 5 JOBS (3 MINUTES)

Write the five tasks you most want help with this month (for example: replying to enquiries, writing posts, summarising meetings). You'll use this list to test each assistant.

SECTION 02 · THE BIG FOUR

ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini and Copilot in plain English

A simple, general picture. All four have free and paid plans, and all are improving quickly, so use this as a starting point, not a verdict.

Assistant	Made by	Often chosen for	Fits best if you…
ChatGPT	OpenAI	All-round helper, big ecosystem of custom GPTs, voice and image features	Want one flexible assistant for many kinds of tasks
Claude	Anthropic	Long documents, careful writing, natural tone, Projects for shared files	Write a lot and work with long PDFs or reports
Gemini	Google	Works alongside Gmail, Docs, Drive and Sheets (plan-dependent)	Run your business on Google Workspace
Copilot	Microsoft	Works alongside Outlook, Word, Excel and Teams (plan-dependent)	Run your business on Microsoft 365

THE ECOSYSTEM SHORTCUT

If your email, documents and calendar already live in Google or Microsoft, start with that company's assistant. Being close to your files usually matters more than small differences in writing quality.

What they share

- Chat in a browser and in phone apps
- Upload files and images to discuss
- Custom instructions or ‘memory’ so you repeat yourself less
- Business or team plans with extra admin and privacy controls

SECTION 03 · DECIDE

The 3-question decision checklist

Answer three questions honestly. Most people have a clear first choice in under five minutes.

Q1 · WHERE DO YOU WORK?
Google, Microsoft or a mix of apps?

▶

Q2 · WHAT'S YOUR MAIN JOB?
Writing, documents, data or a bit of everything?

▶

Q3 · WHAT ARE YOUR LIMITS?
Budget, privacy needs and team size

If your answer is...	Try first	Runner-up
Gmail, Google Docs and Drive every day	Gemini	ChatGPT or Claude
Outlook, Word, Excel and Teams every day	Copilot	ChatGPT or Claude
Mostly long writing, reports and PDFs	Claude	ChatGPT
A bit of everything, many different tasks	ChatGPT	Claude or Gemini
Strict client confidentiality	A business plan of the tool your company already trusts	Check data settings first

DON'T BUY FOUR SUBSCRIPTIONS

Pick **one** assistant for 30 days. Switching every week means you never learn any of them well, and your saved instructions and history stay scattered.

EXERCISE 2 · CIRCLE YOUR ANSWERS

Q1: Google / Microsoft / Mixed · Q2: Writing / Documents / Data / Everything · Q3: Free only / Up to about USD 20 a month / Team plan

My first choice:

SECTION 04 · TEST

Run your own 10-minute side-by-side test

Reviews online test generic tasks. Your business is not generic. Give your top two candidates the same three real tasks and compare.

1. Open your top two assistants in two browser tabs (free plans are fine).
2. Paste the **same** prompt into both. Use the three test prompts below.
3. Score each answer from 1 to 5 using the scorecard.
4. Pick the winner. A tie? Choose the one closest to your email and files.

TEST PROMPT A · WRITING

Write a friendly reply to a customer asking [COMMON QUESTION]. Our business is [BUSINESS]. Under 100 words, end with one clear next step.

TEST PROMPT B · SUMMARY

Summarise this text in 5 bullet points for a busy owner, then list 3 actions: [PASTE A LONG EMAIL OR DOCUMENT, NO PRIVATE DATA].

TEST PROMPT C · THINKING

I have [BUDGET] and [HOURS PER WEEK] to get more customers for [BUSINESS] in [CITY]. Give me a simple 4-week plan. Ask me 3 questions first.

Score 1–5	Accuracy	Tone fits me	Useful as-is	Speed	Total
Assistant 1					
Assistant 2					

SECTION 05 · SET UP

Set up your assistant in 15 minutes

Menu names differ between tools and change over time, but the same four settings exist in some form in all of them. Look in Settings or your profile menu.

Setting	Where to look (typical)	What to do
Custom instructions / personalisation	Settings → Personalisation or Profile	Tell it who you are and how to answer (template below)
Memory	Settings → Personalisation / Memory	Decide if it may remember details. Review what it saved.
Data controls / training	Settings → Data controls or Privacy	Check whether chats may be used to improve models; switch off if you prefer
Chat history	Settings or sidebar	Delete chats that contained anything sensitive

TEMPLATE · CUSTOM INSTRUCTIONS

About me: I run [BUSINESS] in [CITY/COUNTRY], serving [CUSTOMERS]. Team size: [NUMBER].
How to answer: plain English, short paragraphs, practical steps. Use [CURRENCY] and [COUNTRY] context.
Always: ask up to 3 questions if my request is unclear; flag anything I should double-check.
Never: invent prices, laws or facts about my business.

BEFORE YOU PASTE ANYTHING

Don't paste passwords, full card or bank numbers, ID numbers, or customers' personal details into a free or personal AI account. Remove names and numbers first, or use a business plan your company has approved.

SECTION 06 · CONTEXT

Write your one-page business context note

The fastest upgrade to any assistant is context. Write one short note about your business, save it, and paste it in (or upload it to a Project, Gem or custom GPT) whenever you start important work.

Section	Your details
Business & location	
What we sell (top 3 products/services + prices)	
Ideal customers	
What makes us different	
Tone of voice (3 words)	
Words we never use	
Key facts (hours, delivery, refund policy)	

PROMPT · DRAFT THE NOTE FOR YOU

Interview me to write a one-page 'business context note' for AI assistants. Ask me one question at a time about my business, customers, products, tone and key policies. After 8 questions, write the note in clear bullet points.

KEEP IT ALIVE

Update the note whenever prices, hours or policies change. Old facts in your note become wrong answers in your replies.

SECTION 07 · PLANS

Free or paid? When an upgrade is worth it

Free plans are enough to learn and to handle light daily use. Upgrade when the assistant is clearly saving you time and you keep hitting a limit.

Sign you need an upgrade	Typical fix
You hit message or usage limits most days	Individual paid plan
You need longer files or more uploads	Paid plan with larger limits
Staff need shared instructions and files	Team or business plan
Clients ask how you protect their data	Business plan with admin and data controls
You want AI inside Gmail/Docs or Outlook/Word	The matching Google or Microsoft add-on

Individual paid plans of the big four have often been priced around **USD 20 a month**, with team plans costing more per person. Prices and plans change; check the official pricing page before you pay and note your renewal date.

EXERCISE 3 · IS IT WORTH IT?

Hours saved per week × your hourly value = monthly value. If it is clearly more than the subscription, upgrade. If not, stay free for another month.

__ hours × __ × 4 = _____ per month

- [ ] I used the free plan for at least 2 weeks
- [ ] I hit a real limit, more than once
- [ ] I know the renewal date and how to cancel

SECTION 08 · HABIT

Your 7-day habit plan

Choosing is step one. Using it every day for a week is what makes it stick.

Day	Action	Time (est.)	Done
1	Answer the 3 questions; pick your assistant	5 min	
2	Add custom instructions; check privacy settings	10 min	
3	Write your business context note with the interview prompt	15 min	
4	Use it for 3 customer replies (check before sending)	15 min	
5	Summarise one long email or document	5 min	
6	Plan next week's tasks or posts with it	15 min	
7	Review: what saved time? Save your 3 best prompts	10 min	

Times are rough estimates and vary by person.

PROMPT · WEEKLY REVIEW

This week I used you for: [TASKS]. What worked: [WINS]. What didn't: [PROBLEMS].
Suggest 3 better ways to use you next week and rewrite my best prompt to be even clearer.

Safety checklist

- [ ] I checked facts, numbers and dates before using any answer
- [ ] No private customer data in a personal account
- [ ] I know where my settings for memory and data use are

WHAT'S NEXT

You've picked your assistant. Now put it to work.

One assistant, set up well, with a context note: that's the foundation for every other Coaching Codex guide.

50 Copy-Paste AI Prompts for Small Business Owners

Fifty ready prompts for marketing, sales, service, admin and planning.

Custom AI Assistants for Your Business

Turn your context note into a reusable GPT, Gem or Project.

Write a Week of Social Media Posts in 30 Minutes

Plan, write and schedule seven posts in one sitting.

AI Safety & Privacy for Small Businesses

A one-page AI policy for you and your team.

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